COMPUTER MAY CRY

THESIS

[MARCH 2026]

WHAT IS THIS?

1. AT THIS POINT, [MARCH 3, 2026] THE PROJECT IS JUST A TOOL THAT SCRAPES RANDOM YOUTUBE VIDEOS WITH LESS THAN 20 VIEWS AND EDITS THEM TO A SONG.

HOW DID IT START?

2. I FIND THIS FUNDAMENTALLY INTERESTING FOR A VIEW REASONS. PERHAPS MOST IMPORTANTLY BECAUSE IT LOOKS GOOD. BEYOND THAT, I THINK THERE IS SOMETHING TO BE SAID ABOUT THE VALUE OF IMAGES. (WHAT IS ONE IMAGE WORTH IF THE INTERNET AND AI WILL BIRTH THEM ENDLESSLY?) IT'S SOMETHING I VISITED WITH ENDOTICA.ORG AND I THINK ITS THE SAME THING. YOU CAN CREATE SENTIMENTALITY THROUGH FORGOTTEN IMAGES

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3. CAN I CREATE A SYSTEM THAT RE-INCORCES AND LEARNS FROM ITSELF? IN OTHER WORDS, <u>CAN I TEACH A COMPUTER TO RECOGNIZE EMOTIONAL RESONANCE AND BUILD ON THAT?</u>

WHAT IS THE GOAL?

4. I WANT TO AVOID GETTING TOO THE-ORETICAL ABOUT WHAT A COMPUTER LEARNING EMOTIONS MEANS. IT'S JUST CODE. BUT IT DOES REQUIRE ME, THE HUMAN, TO TRY TO CONTEXTUALIZE SENTIMENTALITY INTO OB-JECTIVE FACTS THAT A COMPUTER CAN UN-DERSTAND BOTH IN MUSIC AND IN VISUALS. WHICH IS AN IMPORTANT EXERCISE BEYONG THIS PROJECT.

HOW DO YOU DO IT?

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5. THE INHERENT LIMITATIONS OF THE COMPUTER MEAN THAT THERE ARE CERTAIN THINGS IT CAN'T DO, WHICH REALLY DEFINE A LARGE PART OF WHAT IS POSSIBLE. MUSICALLY, IT CAN RECOGNIZE TEMPO, BEATS, AND LOOSELY IDENTIFY SONG STRUCTURE. VISUALLY, IT CAN IDENTIFY THUMBNAILS AS THEY GET LOADED IN, WITHOUT USING TOO MUCH AI IT CAN IDENTIFY COLOR AND GENERAL CONTENT.

WHAT ARE THE OBJECTIVE FACTS?

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WHAT DO WE NEED TO DO THIS?

6. THE BIGGEST PART IN ALL OF THIS FOR ME IS TRYING TO DISTILL WHAT IN AN IMAGE MAKES IT MEANINGFUL TO HUMANS. TO ME, EMOTIONAL RESONANCE IS OBVIOUSLY REPRESENTED THROUGH CONTENT. WHAT IS ACTUALLY BEING SHOWN. WHICH ITSELF IS PRESENTED BY COLORS AND FORMS THAT WE IDENTIFY. I THINK FUTHER THOUGH THERE IS A LOT OF WHAT MAKES UP EMOTIONAL RESONANCE THAT IS CULTURAL, AND THIS PART IS MUCH HARDER TO DEFINE. AN OLD YOUTUBE VIDEO THAT REMINDS ME OF MY CHILDHOOD IS IMPORTANT BUT HOW DOES THE COMPUTER COME TO UNDERSTAND NOT JUST CONTENT BUT CONTEXT?

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HOW TO DEFINE EMOTIONS THROUGH VISUALS?

[CONT.]

7. WITHOUT GETTING TOO MUCH INTO THE WEEDS OF CULTURE AND CONTEXT IN DEFINING VISUAL LANGUAGE (OR REALLY ANY LANGUAGE), THE NEXT MOST IMPORTANT THING BEYOND CONTENT AND CONTEXT IS THE RELATIONSHIP IMAGES AND VIDEOS HAVE TO THEMSELVES. THE SAME PRINCIPLE EXISTS IN COLOR THEORY WHERE A COLOR CAN REPRESENT ONE THING INDIVIDUALLY AND SOMETHING TOTALLY NEW WITH ANOTHER COLOR NEXT TO IT. THIS IS SPECIFICALLY IMPORTANT IN THE CONTEXT OF VIDEOS. FOR THERE TO BE A SENSE OF SENTIMENTALITY THERE ALSO NEEDS TO BE A SORT OF CONVERSATION BETWEN EACH VIDEO OR IMAGE.

HOW DO YOU TURN THAT INTO A SYSTEM?

8. THROUGH TRIAL AND ERROR AND SOME SORT OF MACHINE LEARNING. BUT TO DO THAT WE FIRST HAVE TO DEFINE EACH KEY ELEMENT IN A VIDEO THAT WE'VE JUST GONE OVER. WE EITHER TEACH IT THROUGH FEEDING IT TO OTHER PEOPLE (LIKE POSTING ON TIK TOK) AND RECORDING ENGAGEMENT. OR WE HAVE IT LEARN FROM OUR OWN BEHAVIOR, WE USE THE SYSTEM AND HAVE IT UNDERSTAND WHAT SORTS OF VIDEOS WE MAKE. MAYBE BOTH? ALWAYS BOTH.

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HOW DO YOU TURN THAT INTO A SYSTEM?

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QUESTIONS

[MARCH 2026]

1. HOW DO WE BUILD THIS?
2. WHAT GETS PRIORITIZED?
3. WHAT IS ALREADY AVAILABLE TO ME ONLINE